

Fig. 1: Example of PhotoView

mono-face PCB useful for hobbyists, I have inserted the jumper component (both SMD and TH), the on-line DRC, the trace current capacity check and more." "Also in the padstack library, you'll see SMD, Through-Hole, Fiducial and Mounting-Hole padstack, which creates the possibility to have slot holes, offsetting pads and tolerance. The library manager is similar to PADS (Mentor Graphics) with a lot of info on it," he adds.

This tool can be used to make single- or double-sided PCBs, and has a component library with more than a thousand footprints. With the presence of auto jumpers, whilst routing, it is possible to invoke the jumper list and place the selected jumper on top or the bottom.

There is also a PhotoView feature

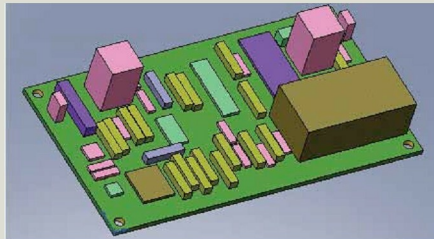


Fig. 2: Exporting IDF in 3D

that allows designers to have a look at the PCB in real time showing through-holes, slots, etc. It is also possible to import a DXF file from commercial CAD tools like AutoCAD, Intellicad and Turbocad. Moreover, you can generate a DXF file to export the project for other mechanical CAD.

Sometimes it might be necessary

for the designer to know the amount of current that a particular trace could carry. Trace Current Capacity feature allows the designer to access that data.

Once you are done with the design, you can use 'Export IDF' option, which exports the project into an ASCII file that contains all 3D information. ZenitPCB uses a component called 'Placement Outline' for the height, and another called 'Obstruct Shapes' for creating areas within which certain operations (placement, routing, copper pour) are not allowed. For creating these areas, you have to use a poly-line shape.

ZenitPCB software basically has three main parts: ZenitPCB Layout, ZenitCapture Schematic and ZenitPCB GerberView.

With ZenitPCB Layout you can realise a project directly from the layout editor by importing components from the library and connecting pins directly with the cursor. It is therefore possible to create a board without importing a net-list from schematic capture

ZenitPCB Layout

ZenitPCB Layout tool helps to create the desired PCB for personal or semi-professional use. It is possible to create the project beginning from the schematic capture and/or to the layout itself.

With this tool, it is possible to:

1. Import a net-list (ASCII file containing electrical information) from different schematic captures (Orcad, Pads1, Multisim, Protel, Eagle) with all the components and relative electrical connections.

2. Realise a project directly from the layout editor by importing components from the library and connecting pins directly with the cursor. It is therefore possible to create a board without importing a net-list from schematic capture.

ZenitCapture Schematic

As the name suggests, ZenitCapture Schematic can be used to create schematic designs. A schematic is basically a sketch of an electrical logic. The basic building blocks of schematic diagrams use a set of standardised symbols to represent different component types. Electrical paths between different component symbols are indicated by the use of wires.

A schematic in ZenitCapture can have several pages and can be led to a layout by a net-list file (ASCII). Additional connections are easy to add with features such as orthogonal locking and snap to pin. Also, global symbols,